

SCHOOL OF LIFE FOUNDATION

The Architecture of *Grace*

Drawing Activities — Book 1 · The Foundation

Fourteen drawing activities for Grades K–2 — one per lesson — that turn each big idea into something young learners can make with their own hands. Each sheet gives a simple prompt, friendly step-by-step guidance, and a space to draw. Print one per student and use during the art portion of the lesson.

Drawing Activities

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Identity Web

Unit 1 · Lesson 1

Students draw their own Identity Web with their name in the centre and 5 branches.

⇒ How to Draw It

- 1 **Branch 1 — LOVE.** Something I love (drawing comics, playing soccer, my dog)
- 2 **Branch 2 — GOOD AT.** Something I'm good at (reading fast, being kind, building things)
- 3 **Branch 3 — MATTERS.** Something that matters to me (my family, being fair, animals)
- 4 **Branch 4 — DON'T KNOW.** Something people don't know about me (optional / private)
- 5 **Branch 5 — FIGURING OUT.** Something I'm still figuring out

Draw it here!

TEACHER Model your own web first on the anchor chart. Students do not share Branch 4 unless they choose to.

Feelings Faces Gallery

Unit 1 · Lesson 2

Students draw or find an emoji-style face showing each feeling from the anchor chart.

⇒ How to Draw It

- 1 **Draw HAPPY.** A big open smile, bright eyes, maybe arms spread wide.
- 2 **Draw SAD.** Drooping shoulders, teary eyes, mouth turned down.
- 3 **Draw ANGRY.** Furrowed brow, fists, big energy in the body.
- 4 **Draw SCARED.** Wide eyes, hunched shoulders, small body.
- 5 Below each face, write or dictate: "This feeling tells me _____."

Draw it here!

TEACHER Model each drawing on the board first. Students can draw or copy. Focus is on the MESSAGE beneath each feeling.

Oops → Fix It → Try Again

Unit 1 · Lesson 3

Students draw a 3-panel comic strip: what went wrong → what they did to fix it → trying again.

⇒ How to Draw It

- 1 Panel 1 — OOPS.** Draw the moment something went wrong (spilling, forgetting, bumping into someone).
- 2 Panel 2 — FIX IT.** Draw what you can do (say sorry, clean up, ask for help).
- 3 Panel 3 — TRY AGAIN.** Draw yourself trying again with a brave face.

Draw it here!

TEACHER Students can use a real memory or make up a situation. Remind them: the FIX IT step is always possible. Model the 3 panels on the board.

Kind Coach Speech Bubble

Unit 1 · Lesson 4

Students draw Sammy the puppet (or a character of their choice) with a speech bubble showing what the KIND COACH would say.

⇒ How to Draw It

- 1 Draw Sammy (or your own character) looking kind and supportive.
- 2 In the speech bubble, write what the KIND COACH would say after a mistake. Example: "Oops! What happened? What can I learn? What's one next step?"
- 3 Next to it, draw Grumpy Gus saying something unkind — then cross it out with a red X.
- 4 Label your drawing: KIND COACH ✓ and GRUMPY GUS ×

Draw it here!

TEACHER Students may draw their own Kind Coach character — it doesn't have to be Sammy. The key is showing the contrast. Display with the anchor chart.

Oops vs. I Am Bad

Unit 1 · Lesson 5

Students illustrate examples from each column of the anchor chart.

⇒ How to Draw It

- 1 Fold paper in half. Label the left side OOPS. Label the right side I AM BAD.
- 2 On the OOPS side: draw or write a behavior example ("I forgot my homework").
- 3 On the I AM BAD side: draw an X through a thought-bubble ("I'm the worst student ever").
- 4 At the bottom, write: "OOPS is OK. I AM BAD is never true."

Draw it here!

TEACHER This can be done as a class sort on the anchor chart first, then individually. Emphasize: no thought goes in the I AM BAD column that***s actually true.

What Forgiveness Carries

Unit 2 · Lesson 1

Students draw a backpack and label what forgiveness does NOT carry (myths) and what it does carry.

⇒ How to Draw It

- 1 Draw a large backpack.
- 2 Write the 4 myths OUTSIDE the backpack (things forgiveness doesn't carry): "Forgetting · Saying it was OK · Weakness · Being ready first."
- 3 Write what forgiveness IS inside the backpack: "Letting go of the heavy feeling · For ME, not for them."
- 4 Optional: draw the backpack getting lighter as the myths are removed.

Draw it here!

TEACHER If using a real backpack as a prop, do that demo first — then students draw. The image of the backpack getting lighter is the key visual.

Three-Part Sorry Scroll

Unit 2 · Lesson 3

Students create a ****scroll**** (long strip of paper folded in 3) showing their three-part sorry practice.

⇒ How to Draw It

- 1 **Panel 1 — PART 1.** Name what happened. "I _____ [specific action]."
- 2 **Panel 2 — PART 2.** Name the hurt. "I know that made you feel _____."
- 3 **Panel 3 — PART 3.** Name the change. "Next time I will _____ instead."
- 4 Decorate with a banner at the top: "A Real Sorry Has Three Parts."

Draw it here!

TEACHER Students practice with a partner — one person reads the scroll, the other responds. It doesn't have to be a real situation. The practice is the point.

Self-Compassion Letter

Unit 2 · Lesson 4

Students illustrate the kind thing they would say to a friend — then write it to themselves.

⇒ How to Draw It

- 1 On the left side of the page: draw a friend who is sad or struggling.
- 2 In a speech bubble next to them: write the kind thing you would say.
- 3 On the right side: draw yourself.
- 4 In a speech bubble: write the same kind thing — but say it to yourself.
- 5 At the bottom: "I deserve the same kindness I give my friends."

Draw it here!

TEACHER This is the core insight of self-compassion. Model by sharing your own example first. The two drawings should look similar — friend and self, same words.

The Letting Go Poster

Unit 2 · Lesson 6

Students create a visual representation of *****putting something down.***

⇒ How to Draw It

- 1 Draw two scenes side by side.
- 2 **Scene 1 — CARRYING IT.** A figure holding a heavy rock or big backpack. Label: "Holding on to the hard feeling."
- 3 **Scene 2 — PUTTING IT DOWN.** The same figure with hands open, rock on the ground. Label: "I put it down. I can pick it up again later if I need to."
- 4 At the bottom: "Putting it down is not the same as forgetting. It's a choice."

Draw it here!

TEACHER Emphasize that putting it down is NOT a permanent decision. Students can pick it up again. This reduces the pressure of *****you must forgive now.***

My Hurt Is Real · Heart Map

Unit 3 · Lesson 1

Students draw a heart and fill it with words or images showing a hurt that is real to them (private or shared).

⇒ How to Draw It

- 1 Draw a large heart on the page.
- 2 Inside the heart: draw or write something that hurt — a time you were left out, ignored, or treated unfairly.
- 3 Students may keep this private — they do NOT have to share.
- 4 Outside the heart: write one sentence: "This hurt is real. My feelings matter."
- 5 Optional: draw a small shield around the heart labelled "SAFE."

Draw it here!

TEACHER This is a private activity first. Validate without probing. Walk through the room and quietly affirm: **"**"Your hurt is real.**"** Collect to check for disclosure indicators.

Forgiveness vs. Trust

Unit 3 · Lesson 3

Students illustrate the two columns of the Forgiveness vs. Trust anchor chart.

⇒ How to Draw It

- 1 Fold paper in two columns. Label them: FORGIVENESS (left) and TRUST (right).
- 2 FORGIVENESS side: draw a figure with their hand on their own heart. Label: "For my peace. I can do this alone."
- 3 TRUST side: draw two figures facing each other with question marks. Label: "Requires both of us. Takes time."
- 4 At the bottom: "I can forgive someone and still choose not to be close to them. That is allowed."

Draw it here!

TEACHER Students often confuse these two. The drawing reinforces that forgiveness is internal — it doesn't require the other person to do anything.

Where Am I On The Path?

Unit 3 · Lesson 4

Students draw their own version of the Forgiveness Path and mark where they currently are with a symbol.

⇒ How to Draw It

- 1 Draw a winding path with 6 stations (use the anchor chart as reference).
- 2 Label each station: Still Hurting · Beginning to Understand · Some Days Better · Choosing to Put it Down · Getting Smaller · I Am OK.
- 3 Students place a star or their initials at where they feel they currently are — this is private.
- 4 Draw arrows showing that the path can go forward AND backward — and that's OK.
- 5 "Wherever I am on this path is the right place to be right now."

Draw it here!

TEACHER This is entirely private. Students should feel no pressure to share their star placement. Collect to watch for students stuck at stage 1.

Grace vs. Doormat

Unit 4 · Lesson 1

Students draw the same situation two ways: once as grace, once as a doormat.

⇒ How to Draw It

- 1 Scenario A — GRACE.** A student choosing to be kind to someone who was rude — but with a strong, upright posture. Label: "My CHOICE. My STRENGTH."
- 2 Scenario B — DOORMAT.** A student accepting bad treatment because they feel they can't say no. Show slumped shoulders. Label: "No choice. No dignity."
- 3** Circle the GRACE drawing.
- 4** At the bottom: "Grace is a choice. A doormat has no choice. Grace is stronger."

Draw it here!

TEACHER The key visual is posture — grace is strong and upright, doormat is collapsed. Students often find the physical distinction helps them understand it.

Pause Practice Comic

Unit 4 · Lesson 3

Students draw a 4-panel comic showing the Pause Practice steps in action.

⇒ How to Draw It

- 1 Panel 1 — SOMETHING HAPPENS.** Draw the confusing moment (someone didn't wave back, walked past without smiling).
- 2 Panel 2 — FIRST THOUGHT.** Show a thought bubble with the harsh / negative interpretation. Label: "My brain's first thought."
- 3 Panel 3 — PAUSE + ASK.** Show the character pressing a pause button. Speech bubble: "What's another explanation?"
- 4 Panel 4 — KIND CHOICE.** Show the character choosing the generous assumption. Label: "I led with kindness."

Draw it here!

TEACHER Model the comic strip on the board first using a real classroom example (names changed). Students work in pairs to come up with their own situation.